

Blue Yeti Nano

A compact microphone for the budding streamer

By Manish "Trigger-Happy" Rajesh | feedback@skoar.in

With streaming becoming increasingly popular, the importance of a good microphone can mean the difference between a quality stream and, well, garbage. Blue is already a famous name in the streaming scene, and they've now come out with their most affordable offering yet.

Q SKOAR!: We are familiar with the Blue Yeti. It's very popular among streamers and content creators. Now you've got the Blue Yeti Nano. What are the main differences between the Blue Yeti and the Blue Yeti Nano? What are you sacrificing in the Nano to justify a cheaper price point?

A Roopak: Let's not look at the Nano as sacrificing something, let's look at it from the user point of view. Right now we have launched two products, the Yeti X, which is a professional USB microphone meant for very high-end streamers or gamers or broadcasters or live streamers. The Nano is for budding content creators; an entry level product. We are not sacrificing anything from the technology point of view or from the Blue Voice vocal software.

If you are familiar with microphones, they come with polar patterns. If a mic has four polar patterns, it basically has four capsule condensers. The Blue Yeti Nano is targeted at initial users, and what they generally need is a cardioid pattern. This is a unidirectional polar pattern, which picks up voice from only one direction. Now, in case there are streamers who do interviews, or there is something very popular now called ASMR, for those you need an omnidirectional pattern. Omnidirectional pattern has an advantage that you can have multiple people sitting around and Cardioid is for when you're talking from the front. So the word sacrifice may not apply here; it is more from the usage

point of view. If you are a professional user, we have an option, if you are a budding user and you want to start with a very professional quality product, then we have the Blue Yeti Nano.

Coming to the Blue Voice vocal effect. We have now integrated it with Logitech G Hub. We have now made it bigger and included blue voice vocal effects with it as well. Many times when you speak you want to make it more exciting so we have a lot of vocal effects built into it. This is all available to the Blue Yeti Nano as well.

Q SKOAR!: So, no compromises in the tech, but the Blue Yeti Nano is also smaller. What exactly has been done to achieve a smaller footprint?

A Roopak: Any product that comes to market over a period of time with technological advancements tends to become better and better. You don't need a bigger footprint. So yes, we have made the product compact. Even the new product launched under the professional series, called Yeti X, is more compact. Being compact doesn't mean we have compromised on anything.

Q SKOAR!: So, the Blue Yeti Nano comes only with the unidirectional or Cardioid pattern? Does it have any more patterns?

A Roopak: It has both cardioid and omnidirectional patterns. The other two



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modes, which come with the Blue Yeti X, are the stereo mode and bidirectional mode. Stereo mode is basically used by musicians, when there are multiple people sitting together, you can use stereo mode. Then you have a mode called bidirectional. This picks up audio from the front and directly opposite to you, like an interview setup.

Q SKOAR!: So, like you mentioned, it works with the Logitech G Hub app, but that is specifically for blue voice, correct? Is there any other app that's required to use the Nano?

A Roopak: Yes. There is a Blue Voice vocal effects software, which you used to have earlier, but we have integrated it in such a way that now G Hub also has it. So you no longer need to have two softwares running. You don't need any apps to use the Nano. It's a plug and play. This is a USB-based product. Budding streamers, or even the professional streamers, they work on computers and they don't need an audio interface, you can directly plug in and the product is ready to play.

Q SKOAR!: In the past few years, we've seen a bigger uptick in the number of streamers in India. Before you had the Nano, Blue Yeti was not exactly an affordable purchase. Have you noticed any difference in interest?

A Roopak: We have two product lines. One is the Yeti series and there is also an affordable range called the Snowball series. The Snowball series starts from as low as ₹4,000. The Nano is currently Yeti's most affordable offering. *